

Policies, Terms & Customer Rights

Authoritative policy reference for support agents

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This document is the single source of truth for BharatConnect's customer-facing policies. When a customer asks "what is your policy on...", the answer must come from here. Where a policy interacts with billing or purchases, it also references KB-BILL-003.

1. KYC & Identity Verification

Every new SIM/connection requires Know-Your-Customer (KYC) verification as mandated by the Department of Telecommunications. A customer must provide a valid proof of identity and proof of address.

Accepted documents:

- Aadhaar (with consent-based eKYC), Passport, Voter ID, Driving Licence, or NREGA card.
- A recent passport-size photograph for offline KYC.
- For minors: the connection must be in the name of a parent/guardian.
- **Re-verification:** Customers may be asked to re-verify if regulatory checks flag the number.
- **Limit:** A maximum of 9 SIM connections per individual ID, per DoT rules.

2. Privacy & Data Protection

BharatConnect collects only the data needed to provide service and bill correctly: identity/KYC data, usage records (calls, data volume — not content), billing data, and support interaction history.

- Customer data is never sold to third parties.
- Call/usage **content** is not recorded or read; only metadata (duration, data volume) is stored for billing.
- Support conversations may be recorded and stored for quality and self-improvement of the AI system.
- A customer may request a copy of their data or its deletion (subject to legal retention rules) via the grievance process.
- **Agents must never read out card numbers, full Aadhaar numbers, or OTPs.** Never ask a customer for an OTP.

OTP / fraud guard

BharatConnect agents will **never** ask a customer to share an OTP, PIN, CVV, or full card number. If a customer reports being asked for these by 'BharatConnect', treat it as a suspected scam and advise them not to share, and to report it via the official website.

3. Fair Usage Policy (FUP)

Plans marketed as "unlimited" data carry a Fair Usage Policy. After the high-speed data quota for the plan is consumed, speeds are reduced (throttled) for the remainder of the validity/cycle; the connection is not cut off.

Plan type	High-speed quota	Speed after FUP
Daily-data prepaid	Per-day quota (e.g. 1.5 GB/day)	64 Kbps until next day reset
"Unlimited" prepaid	Defined cap per cycle	128 Kbps after cap
Postpaid unlimited	Defined cap per cycle	256 Kbps after cap
Fiber unlimited	No hard cap; congestion management may apply	Managed during peak hours

Daily-data plans reset the high-speed quota every day at midnight; throttling is temporary, not a penalty.

4. Refund & Cancellation Policy

Because all recharges and add-ons are purchased on the website (see KB-BILL-003), refund rules are tied to that channel.

- **Failed recharge (money debited, recharge not applied):** Auto-reversal within 3–5 working days. If not reversed, the customer raises a request on the website with the transaction reference. Agents help locate the reference and set this expectation.
- **Wrong plan purchased by mistake:** Prepaid recharges, once successfully applied, are generally **non-refundable**; the customer may switch plans at the next recharge.
- **Accidental add-on / OTT auto-renewal:** The customer can cancel future renewals on the website; the current cycle is usually non-refundable but can be reviewed case-by-case.
- **Postpaid disputed charge:** Raised as a billing complaint; if upheld, adjusted on the next bill as a credit.
- **Fiber security deposit / installation:** Refundable per the fiber service agreement on disconnection.

5. Mobile Number Portability (MNP)

Porting in (joining BharatConnect) and porting out are governed by TRAI rules.

5.1 Porting IN to BharatConnect

- Customer sends **PORT <mobile number>** via SMS to 1900 from their current operator's SIM.
- They receive a Unique Porting Code (UPC), valid for a limited window.
- They complete KYC with BharatConnect and submit the UPC (online or at a store).
- Porting typically completes within **3–5 working days**; the number stays the same.

5.2 Porting OUT (leaving)

- Customer must have no outstanding postpaid dues before porting out.
- Prepaid balance/validity is forfeited on porting out.
- Agents should, politely, try to understand and resolve the underlying issue (retention) but must never block or obstruct a port-out request.

6. Complaint & Grievance Redressal

BharatConnect follows the TRAI three-tier grievance process:

Tier	Channel	Resolution target
1 — Support	AI voice support / call centre; docket number issued	Most issues within 48 hours
2 — Nodal Officer	Escalation if Tier-1 unresolved or customer unsatisfied	Within 7 working days
3 — Appellate Authority	Final internal escalation	Within 30 days

Every complaint generates a **docket/complaint number**. Agents must always provide this number so the customer can track the issue.

7. Service Levels & Outages

- Known network outages are logged with an estimated restoration time; agents should give the customer the specific ETA for their area rather than a generic message.
- For a no-network complaint with no known outage, a fault ticket is created and the customer is given a docket number and a callback/SMS expectation.

- Planned maintenance is communicated via SMS in advance where possible.

8. Acceptable Use & Disconnection

- Connections must not be used for spam, fraud, or illegal activity.
- Postpaid connections may be temporarily barred (outgoing) on exceeding the credit limit or on non-payment past the due date; full disconnection follows continued non-payment.
- Reconnection after payment is typically restored within a few hours of cleared dues.